Case Studies and Cases

H 1350

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A. Background

The subdivision ***--Cases***, clinical reports, statistics, formerly used under medical headings, was discontinued in 1979 in favor of the subdivisions ***--Case studies*** and ***--Statistics***. The subdivisions ***--Case studies*** and ***--Cases*** are now the only authorized free-floating subdivisions used for descriptions of cases or works about them. This instruction sheet provides guidelines for assigning the subdivisions ***--Case studies*** and ***--Cases*** and the heading ***Case method***. It also provides guidelines on cataloging works about conducting and writing case studies.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Case studies***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

B. Recent revisions

2026-07: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. Definitions

Case studies: descriptions of one or more recorded instances illustrating the conditions of a particular field, from which general principles may be drawn

D. Case method

Use the heading ***Case method*** as a topical heading for general works on the use of recorded case studies as a method of instruction.

E. Case studies

Case studies are descriptions of one or more recorded instances illustrating the conditions of a particular field, from which general principles may be drawn. Use the free-floating subdivision ***--Case studies*** under classes of persons, ethnic groups, and topical headings, except legal headings.

Under medical headings, including names of diseases, use this subdivision for professional description or analysis of one or more case histories on the topic.

Also use this subdivision under names of individual corporate bodies for case studies involving those corporate bodies.

Code the subdivision as a form subdivision ($v) for works consisting of case studies and as a topical subdivision ($x) for works that discuss case studies.

LC practice: Assign as subject headings the focus of the case study. Also assign the LCGFT term appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Case studies***.

Examples:

```
650 #0 $a Women farmers $z India $v Case studies.
650 #0 $a Juvenile delinquency $x Case studies.
650 #0 $a AIDS (Disease) $v Case studies.
650 #0 $a Blood-vessels $x Endoscopic surgery $x Case studies.
610 20 $a Camden County Children's Shelter $v Case studies.
610 20 $a United Nations $x Case studies $v Bibliography.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Women farmers $z India.
655 #7 $a Case studies. $2 lcgft
```

F. Cases

Use the free-floating form subdivision ***--Cases*** under topical legal headings for compilations of court or regulatory agency decisions on the topic, including reporters or casebooks for students.

LC practice: Assign as subject headings the appropriate legal headings for compilations of court or regulatory agency decisions on a topic. Also assign the LCGFT term appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Casebooks (Law)***.

Examples:

```
650 #0 $a Estates (Law) $v Cases.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Estates (Law)
655 #7 $a Court decisions and opinions. $2 lcgft
```

```
650 #0 $a Torts $v Cases.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Torts.
655 #7 $a Casebooks (Law) $2 lcgft
```

Note: For non-topical compilations, use either ***Law reports, digests, etc.*** (for reporters) or ***Law--Cases*** (for casebooks), as appropriate.

LC practice: For non-topical compilations, assign the LCGFT term appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Casebooks (Law)***.

Also use the free-floating topical subdivision ***--Cases*** under topical legal headings for works about compilations of court or regulatory agency decisions on the topic, including reporters or casebooks for students.

G. Methodology

For works on the methodology of conducting case studies on a particular topic, see H 2020.

H. Authorship

For works on the authorship of case studies in a particular discipline, use the free-floating topical subdivision ***--Authorship*** under the heading for the discipline (e.g., ***Psychiatry--Authorship***).

Revision history

2026-07: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.